

Travel Knowledge Handbook

Purpose

This handbook provides practical travel knowledge for road trips across India. It covers digital travel services, permits, payment methods, emergency assistance, communication, responsible tourism, and frequently asked travel questions. The information is intended to help travelers make informed decisions before and during their journey.

1. Essential Travel Documents

Before beginning any road trip, travelers should ensure they have access to the following documents.

Personal Documents

- Government-issued Photo ID
- Driving License
- Passport (for foreign nationals)
- Medical prescriptions (if applicable)

Vehicle Documents

- Registration Certificate (RC)
- Insurance Certificate
- Pollution Under Control (PUC) Certificate (where applicable)
- Vehicle permit (if required)

Digital Copies

It is recommended to keep digital copies of important documents on your mobile device or in a secure digital document storage service.

2. DigiLocker

DigiLocker is a Government of India digital document storage platform.

Commonly stored documents include:

- Driving License
- Registration Certificate
- Aadhaar Card
- PAN Card

Recommendations

- Keep the DigiLocker application installed.
- Ensure documents are synchronized before travel.
- Carry physical copies whenever legally required.

3. FASTag

FASTag is an electronic toll payment system used on most National Highways.

Benefits

- Faster toll payments
- Reduced waiting time
- Cashless transactions

Recommendations

- Maintain sufficient balance.
- Check account status before long trips.
- Keep an alternative payment method available.

4. Digital Payments

Recommended payment methods

- UPI
- Debit Card
- Credit Card
- Limited Cash

Recommendations

- Do not rely on a single payment method.
- Carry small cash denominations for remote locations.
- Enable transaction notifications.

5. Mobile Connectivity

Network availability may vary in remote and mountainous regions.

Recommendations

- Download offline maps before departure.
- Inform family members when entering low-network areas.
- Carry emergency contact numbers offline.

6. Navigation

Recommended navigation practices

- Plan the route before departure.
- Download offline maps.
- Save hotel and destination locations.
- Verify alternate routes.

Avoid depending entirely on mobile data.

7. Accommodation Tips

Before booking accommodation:

- Read recent reviews.
- Verify location.
- Check parking availability.
- Confirm cancellation policy.
- Verify check-in and check-out timings.

8. Fuel Planning

Recommendations

- Refuel before entering remote regions.
- Avoid allowing fuel to fall below one-quarter tank.
- Locate nearby fuel stations before beginning long stretches.

9. Travel Permits

Certain destinations in India may require special permits.

Examples include:

- Protected border regions
- Wildlife reserves
- National parks
- Certain mountain passes

Recommendations

- Verify permit requirements before travel.
- Apply through official government portals where applicable.
- Carry printed or digital copies of approved permits.

10. Highway Assistance

If assistance is required during highway travel:

- Move the vehicle to a safe location.
- Switch on hazard lights.
- Contact emergency services or roadside assistance.
- Remain away from moving traffic.

11. Responsible Tourism

Travel responsibly by following these practices.

Environmental Responsibility

- Do not litter.
- Carry reusable water bottles.
- Avoid single-use plastics.
- Respect wildlife.

Cultural Responsibility

- Respect local customs.
- Dress appropriately at religious sites.
- Ask permission before photographing people.
- Support local businesses whenever possible.

12. Solo Travel Tips

Recommendations

- Share your itinerary with trusted contacts.
- Avoid isolated locations after dark.
- Book verified accommodation.
- Keep emergency contacts readily accessible.
- Stay aware of your surroundings.

13. Group Travel Tips

Recommendations

- Assign meeting points.
- Share live locations when appropriate.
- Maintain communication.
- Keep emergency contacts for all travelers.

- Carry a shared first aid kit.

14. Internet & Communication

Before traveling:

- Download offline maps.
- Save important phone numbers.
- Store hotel addresses offline.
- Charge communication devices.

15. Common Travel Questions

Q: Should I carry cash?

Carry a small amount of cash while using secure digital payment methods whenever possible.

Q: Should I download offline maps?

Yes. Offline maps are recommended for areas with limited mobile connectivity.

Q: Is FASTag useful?

Yes. FASTag reduces waiting time at toll plazas and supports cashless toll payments.

Q: Should I keep digital copies of documents?

Yes. Digital copies provide convenient backup access. Travelers should also comply with local legal requirements regarding original documents.

Q: What should I do if I lose my wallet?

Block bank cards immediately, inform your bank, report the loss if necessary, and use emergency payment options where available.

Q: What should I do if my mobile phone is lost?

Attempt to locate the device using available tracking services, block the SIM card through your mobile network provider, and inform trusted contacts.

Q: What if I lose important travel documents?

Report the loss to the relevant authorities if required and access digital backups where available.

16. Useful Emergency Contacts (India)

Service	Contact
National Emergency	112
Ambulance	108
Police	100

Fire	101
Women Helpline	1091
National Highway Helpline	1033

17. Quick Travel Checklist

Before beginning your journey, confirm:

- ✓ Documents available
- ✓ Digital copies backed up
- ✓ FASTag balance checked
- ✓ Payment methods ready
- ✓ Offline maps downloaded
- ✓ Emergency contacts saved
- ✓ Accommodation confirmed
- ✓ Mobile phone fully charged